



BNU

Professional Practices (HUM-305)

SPRING SEMESTER 2026

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Chap 1: Introduction to Professional Practices & What Is Ethics?

- o What Is Ethics?
- o A Variety of Ethical Views
- o Some Important Distinctions
- o E-commerce and Free Stuff
- o Artificial Intelligence, Robotics, Sensors, and Motion



Professional

Definition:

- o A **professional** is a person who has specialized education, training, and skills in a particular field and applies them competently and ethically to earn a livelihood.

Key Characteristics:

- o Specialized knowledge
- o Formal education or certification
- o Practical skills
- o Ethical behavior
- o Responsibility and accountability

Professional

CS / IT Example:

- o A **Software Engineer** working at Google.
- o A **Cybersecurity Analyst** protecting data in a bank.
- o A **Network Administrator** managing servers in an organization.

Example:

If a Software Developer designs secure applications, meets deadlines, and follows ethical coding standards, he/she is acting as a **professional**.

Profession

Definition:

- o A **profession** is an occupation that requires specialized education, training, intellectual skills, and adherence to a code of ethics.

Key Elements:

- o Formal qualification (degree/certification)
- o Professional standards
- o Code of ethics
- o Continuous learning
- o Service to society

Profession

Examples of Professions:

- o Medicine
- o Law
- o Engineering
- o Teaching
- o Computer Science / IT

CS / IT as a Profession:

- o Computer Science became a recognized profession because:
- o It requires formal education (BSCS, MSCS, Certifications).
- o It follows ethical guidelines (like privacy and data protection).
- o It serves society (software systems, healthcare systems, AI, banking systems).

Profession

Example:

Working as a Data Scientist at Microsoft is part of the **IT profession** because it involves specialized skills and ethical responsibilities

Professionalism

Definition:

- o Professionalism refers to the behavior, attitude, and standards expected from a professional while performing their duties.
- o It is about **how** a professional behaves, not just what they know.

Core Components of Professionalism:

- o Competence
- o Integrity
- o Accountability
- o Respect
- o Ethical behavior
- o Communication skills
- o Time management

Professionalism

Professionalism in CS / IT (Detailed Explanation)

1: Technical Competence

- Writing clean and secure code.
- Using correct algorithms and data structures.
- Testing software properly before deployment.

Example:

A developer ensures software has no major security vulnerabilities before release.

Professionalism

2: Ethical Responsibility

- o Following ethical codes such as those from Association for Computing Machinery (ACM Code of Ethics).
- o Ethical issues in IT:
- o Data privacy
- o Intellectual property
- o Plagiarism
- o Cybercrime
- o AI bias

Example:

A database administrator does not misuse users' personal data.

- o **Accountability**
- o Taking responsibility for errors.
- o Fixing bugs promptly.
- o Not blaming others.



Example:

Professionalism

2: Ethical Responsibility

- o Following ethical codes such as those from Association for Computing Machinery (ACM Code of Ethics).
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Professionalism

3: Accountability

- o Taking responsibility for errors.
- o Fixing bugs promptly.
- o Not blaming others.

Example:

If a system crashes due to your code, you accept responsibility and fix it.

4: Communication

- o Explaining technical issues to non-technical clients.
- o Writing proper documentation.
- o Team collaboration.

Example:

A Project Manager clearly explains software requirements to developers.

Professionalism

5: Continuous Learning

IT changes rapidly:

- o Artificial Intelligence
- o Cloud Computing
- o Cybersecurity
- o Blockchain
- o A professional must update skills regularly.

Example:

A developer learns new frameworks like React or new programming languages.

Ethics

- o **Ethics**, the discipline concerned with what is morally good and bad and morally right and wrong. The term is also applied to any system or theory of moral values or principles.
- o Ethics deals with such questions at all levels. Its subject consists of the fundamental issues of practical decision making, and its major concerns include the nature of ultimate value and the standards by which human actions can be judged right or wrong.

Ethics

- o The terms *ethics* and morality are closely related. It is now common to refer to ethical judgments or to ethical principles where it once would have been more accurate to speak of moral judgments or moral principles.
- o These applications are an extension of the meaning of ethics. In earlier usage, the term referred not to morality itself but to the field of study, or branch of inquiry, that has morality as its subject matter.
- o In this sense, ethics is equivalent to moral philosophy.

Ethics

1. What Is Ethics?

- o Ethics is a systematic study of moral principles that govern human behavior and decision-making. It helps individuals and organizations determine what actions are **right, wrong, fair, or unjust**.

Key Elements of Ethics

- o Values: Honesty, integrity, fairness, responsibility
- o Moral reasoning: Logical thinking about moral problems
- o Accountability: Taking responsibility for decisions and outcomes

Ethics in Professional and Business Life

- o Guides managerial decisions beyond legal requirements
- o Builds trust, reputation, and social responsibility
- o Helps manage conflicts between profit and societal welfare

Example

- o A company may legally sell customer data, but ethically it should obtain informed consent and ensure data protection.

Ethics

- o Although ethics has always been viewed as a branch of philosophy, its all-embracing practical nature links it with many other areas of study, including anthropology, biology, economics, history, politics, sociology, and theology.
- o Yet, ethics remains distinct from such disciplines because it is not a matter of factual knowledge in the way that the sciences and other branches of inquiry are.
- o Rather, it has to do with determining the nature of normative theories and applying these sets of principles to practical moral problems.

Ethics

- o This article, then, will deal with ethics as a field of philosophy, especially as it has developed in the West.
- o For coverage of religious conceptions of ethics and the ethical systems associated with world religions, *see* Buddhism; Christianity; Confucianism; Hinduism; Jainism; Judaism; Sikhism.
- o There are so many branches of philosophy and ethics is one of the branch of philosophy and in ethics we teach what is right and wrong.

Relationship between Ethics & Philosophy

- o Now Ethics and Morality difference is majorly lies on what is right and wrong
- o Example Six and Nine 69, moral or immoral but still difference occurs.
- o First origin of morality come from the term “**MORES**” which means “**Customs and Traditions**”
- o Every society has its own morality and it has its own dos and dosnt
- o Morality origin based upon customs and traditions that is why Greek philosopher used moral or social term as interchangeably.

Relationship between Ethics & Philosophy

- Morality is our customs and traditions means a way of life .
- Now we are heading towards similarity between ethics and molarity from both perspectives what is right and wrong but the fundamental difference of ethics or molarity is Ethics is conscious intellectual enterprise means consciously critical thinking.
- Ethics is a parameter or standards to check the morality.
- Any society / State customs or tradition dowry / triple talaq, it's a part of molarity. Is is based on rationality or reasonably.
- If we need thinking on it we required ethics so ethics is called to be rational thinking.

Relationship between Ethics & Philosophy

How origin of ethics come?

- o The origin of ethics come from molarity and molarity origin come from religion because first source of right and wrong is religion but with the passage of time human start making questions on culture practices which is based on religion, doing mind application and do critical thinking and this is how the origin of ethics come.
- o Sometime some things might be ethical or some are rational but in particular society there will be no acceptability e.g
 - o **MEN = WOMEN treat equally but social morality says something else.**
- o In Nutshell morality is a part & parcel of any society we can see molarity in social norms do's and dosnt but the philosopher using their intellectual curiosity / Intellectual & critical power they go for analysis, if something is moral but it is rational also, it has to be practical and it has to be rejected.

A Variety of Ethical Views

Different ethical theories provide different lenses for moral decision-making:

a) Utilitarianism

- o Proposed by Jeremy Bentham and John Stuart Mill
- o Judges actions based on outcomes or consequences
- o Ethical if it maximizes overall happiness or benefit

Strengths

- o Practical and result-oriented
- o Useful for public policy and business decisions

Limitations

- o May ignore minority rights
- o Difficult to measure happiness accurately

A Variety of Ethical Views

b) Rights-Based Ethics

- o Emphasizes basic human rights
- o Certain actions are unethical regardless of outcomes

Common Rights

- o Right to privacy
- o Right to freedom of expression
- o Right to informed consent

Limitation

- o Conflicts arise when rights compete

A Variety of Ethical Views

c) Justice and Fairness Approach

- o Focuses on equitable treatment
- o Based on theories of John Rawls

Principles

- o Equal opportunities
- o Fair distribution of resources and risks

Application

- o Used in HR policies, wage systems, and access to technology.

A Variety of Ethical Views

d) Virtue Ethics

- o Originates from Aristotle
- o Focuses on moral character rather than rules or outcomes

Key Virtues

- o Honesty
- o Courage
- o Responsibility
- o Compassion

Limitation

- o Less guidance in complex ethical dilemmas

Some Important Distinctions

- o Understanding ethics requires distinguishing between key concepts:

a) Ethics vs Law

- o **Law:** Minimum standards enforced by government
- o **Ethics:** Higher moral standards, not always legally required
 - ✓ Something can be **legal but unethical**

b) Ethics vs Morality

- o **Morality:** Personal or cultural beliefs
- o **Ethics:** Systematic reasoning about moral issues

c) Ethical Dilemma

- o A situation where **no option is completely right**
- o Choosing one ethical principle may violate another

E-commerce and Free Stuff

- E-commerce platforms often offer “free” services (e.g., social media, apps, cloud storage).

Ethical Issues Involved

- User data collection and privacy
- Lack of transparency about how data is used
- Manipulation through targeted advertising
- 👉 *If you're not paying money, you may be paying with your data.*

Ethical Question

- Is it ethical to offer “free” services without clearly informing users of the real cost?

Artificial Intelligence, Robotics, Sensors, and Motion

Modern technologies raise **new ethical challenges**:

a) Artificial Intelligence (AI)

- o Bias in algorithms
- o Lack of accountability in automated decisions
- o Job displacement

b) Robotics

- o Replacement of human labor
- o Safety and responsibility for robot actions

Artificial Intelligence, Robotics, Sensors, and Motion

c) Sensors & Motion Technologies

- o Surveillance and loss of privacy
- o Tracking individuals without consent

Key Ethical Concerns

- o Transparency
- o Privacy protection
- o Human control over machines

Business Ethics

- o Business ethics are the moral principles and standards that guide behavior in the business world, encompassing values like honesty, integrity, fairness, and accountability in all aspects of business operations.
- o Business ethics are the moral principles and standards that guide behavior in the business world, going beyond legal requirements to establish a code of conduct that drives employee behavior and builds trust.

Business Ethics

- o **Business ethics** as “**the rules, principles, and standards of deciding what is morally right or wrong when working.**” So, business ethics refers to the implementation of appropriate business practices and policies in the workplace.
- o There are seven principles of business ethics including
 - o **Accountability,**
 - o **Care and respect,**
 - o **Honesty,**
 - o **Healthy competition,**
 - o **Loyalty,**
 - o **Transparency,**
 - o **Respect for the rule of law.**

What is the purpose of the ethics?

- Ethics is what guides us to tell the truth, keep our promises, or help someone in need.
- There is a framework of ethics underlying our lives on a daily basis, helping us make decisions that create positive impacts and steering us away from unjust outcomes.



Difference between ethics, morality and laws

Ethics Definition:

- Ethics, as a philosophical discipline, is the study of moral principles and the reasoning behind them.

Basis:

- Ethics often involves a more systematic and rational examination of moral issues and values.

Enforcement:

- Ethical principles are often implemented through codes of conduct within professions or organizations, and while they may not always be legally binding, they can have significant professional and social consequences.

Example:

- A professional code of ethics might state that a doctor has a duty to "do no harm," which is a principle guiding their conduct.

Difference between ethics, morality and laws

Morality Definition:

- Morality encompasses a set of personal or societal standards that guide behavior, defining what is considered right or wrong, good or bad.

Basis:

- Morality is often rooted in cultural norms, religious beliefs, and individual values.

Enforcement:

- Morality is typically enforced through social pressure, peer opinion, and personal conscience, rather than formal legal mechanisms.

Example:

- A moral principle might be "honesty is always the best policy," which is a widely held belief about right and wrong.

Difference between ethics, morality and laws

Law Definition:

- o Law is a system of rules and regulations established by a governing authority to maintain order and regulate behavior within a society.

Basis:

- o Laws are typically enacted through formal legislative processes and are binding on all citizens within a jurisdiction.

Enforcement:

- o Laws are enforced through formal legal systems, including courts, police, and other law enforcement agencies, with penalties for violations.

Example:

- o A law might prohibit speeding, with penalties such as fines or imprisonment for those who violate it.